

## Chapter 161-1

Liang Shi's gaze happened to meet Zhao Xuning's.

Almost instantly, Liang Shi knew what Zhao Xuning was thinking.

The two of them had the same thought.

However, Feng Xian frowned and said: "Is that even possible? It was already a stillborn—what would be the point of stealing it? Besides, I never heard that Shi'an Hospital lost a child during those days."

"Was it abandoned because it died young?" Feng Xian continued to speculate.

Zhao Xuning slowly shook her head: "Even if it died young, the probability of abandonment is very low."

Feng Xian was quite intelligent. Her gaze swept back and forth between Zhao Xuning and Liang Shi, then she said: "Do you already know who it is?"

Liang Shi slowly shook her head, her voice very soft: "Still not certain."

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Regardless of anything else, it was a great blessing that Gu Xingyue and Feng Xian could reunite.

Both had been alone and lonely—now they could depend on each other.

On the way home, Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning felt somewhat heavy-hearted. The topic mentioned earlier was quite sensitive, and neither wanted to say more.

This created a silent atmosphere.

Liang Shi couldn't stand it and turned on a song.

It happened to be an old Cantonese love song.

Outside, the trees were still bare. The harsh winter in Haizhou City had not yet passed.

This winter seemed particularly long.

Inside the car, the love song was sung with heartbreaking emotion. The dim yellow streetlights refracted through the car windows, casting gentle light on both their faces.

After a long while, Zhao Xuning said: "Shi'an Hospital has shares from the Shen family."

Liang Shi happened to swallow her saliva, and the gulping sound was quite jarring in the quiet atmosphere.

"So what?" The moment Liang Shi asked, she realized her tone was a bit harsh. She lightly pressed her lips together. "Sorry."

"It's fine." Zhao Xuning said, "Just telling you. Don't overthink it."

Liang Shi: "....."

Zhao Xuning really was someone who didn't like to meddle in others' affairs.

All the way until they got home, she didn't bring up this matter again.

Liang Shi suspected that if Feng Xian hadn't once been Zhao Xuning's benefactor and teacher, Zhao Xuning probably wouldn't have bothered to do the DNA comparison between Feng Xian and Gu Xingyue.

Even though Zhao Xuning said not to overthink it, the logic already laid out before her made it impossible not to.

It was just that there was nothing to use for a DNA comparison.

Liang Shi even dreamed about this matter at night.

But it wasn't exactly a pleasant dream. When acknowledging kinship with the Shen family, she was extremely frightened.

She woke up startled in the middle of the night. After getting up to pour half a glass of water in the kitchen, she couldn't fall back asleep.

Lately, she often found herself in this state—groggy and living through her days in low spirits.

She would suddenly feel sad in bustling crowds, and feel lonely when staying home alone.

She kept thinking about Xu Qingzhu. One night she even buried herself under the covers and cried, and the next day her eyes were swollen beyond recognition.

The day she received Xu Qingzhu's call happened to be the night before she had to go for an audition.

To make sure she would be in good shape, she had taken melatonin the night before.

So she had a rare, deep sleep.

But after being woken by the phone call, she didn't feel irritated. Instead, her heart ached in waves.

After hanging up, she tried to fall asleep again but couldn't sleep well no matter what.

The next day when she went to the audition, she wasn't in the best condition.

This was a pretty good opportunity for a newcomer. The agent had always been measured in arranging these things, progressing step by step, and had even designed a persona and marketing route for her.

Having Liang Shi take the gentle yet commanding big sister<sup>1</sup> route would fit the movie better.

This time, the director was one of the better ones in China for light comedy films, and the role Liang Shi was auditioning for was the only tearjerker in the light comedy.

Because her character would die in the end.

Liang Shi didn't think she couldn't act it. On the contrary, she was very professional.

It was just that not sleeping well the night before had affected her a little. She hadn't reached her best state, and there were many competitors auditioning alongside her, all showcasing their talents. As a newcomer in this field, she wasn't among the top contenders.

But she had already done her best.

Coming out of the audition venue with her agent, the agent had even bought two ice cream cones. On such a cold day, the two of them stood in a corner downstairs eating ice cream.

Liang Shi teased her: "Is it because my performance made your heart go cold?"

The agent: "....."

The agent didn't respond to her cold joke<sup>2</sup>. She just flipped through Liang Shi's schedule and told her about this week's arrangements.

Making reasonable use of all her time.

Liang Shi readily accepted.

The days that followed flew by. The agent didn't let Liang Shi idle at all.

Appearing in magazines that weren't very popular to get exposure, auditioning at different production crews, and going on some lukewarm variety shows as a guest.

Until the day "Happy Tropic" aired.

Unexpectedly, the production team actually used Liang Shi's red outfit look and fan dance as a gimmick.

They especially used a 20-second video, edited out Liang Shi's solo cut, and bought a hot search. The hashtag was called #The Sister in Red Who Amazed Netizens is Back#

A super long hashtag.

Netizens below unanimously commented: 【Yang Shuyan?】

Yang Shuyan's red outfit look in that movie was indeed very popular. The well-known "red outfit kill" that everyone knew came from her.

It wasn't even promoted by fans—it was voted on by passersby.

But when they clicked into the hashtag, they found it was Liang Shi.

The comment section immediately exploded into chaos.

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## Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> **Gentle yet commanding big sister (溫柔禦姐):** "禦姐" (yù jiě) is a term derived from Japanese ("onee-san") referring to a mature, elegant, and often slightly domineering older sister type. Combined with "gentle," it describes a persona that is both warm and sophisticated with a commanding presence.

<sup>2</sup> **Cold joke (冷笑話):** A Chinese term for a "cold joke" or "dry humor"—a pun or joke that's so bad or unfunny that it makes people feel "cold" rather than amused. Here, Liang Shi made a pun connecting "cold" (from the ice cream) with her performance making the agent's "heart go cold" (disappointed).